

Taiga: The Trouble-free Way to Manage Your Project



Have you ever faced a time crunch when trying to finish tasks ahead of a deadline? Or has your work suffered because of resource mismanagement, or a cost crunch during the final stages of a project? To be honest, I have faced a lot of these challenges. When I look back, the basic reason for these hiccups was that the project was not well planned. It isn't that I don't use project management tools; I try to use them — but more often than not, the tool no longer has valid data, because no one in the team feels like updating it regularly. On a search for new software to manage my project, I came across Taiga. And that was where my search ended. Its simplicity and effective design differentiates Taiga from others. It's easy to use for everyone, be it a developer, manager, tester or any other stakeholder.

Taiga is an open source software platform for project management with intuitive features that match its user's needs. As the developers claim, it's designed so well, it is beautiful to look at all day long. As of now, all projects are private, but starting from April 2015, projects will be free, provided a user agrees that they can be included in Taiga's public registry. Taiga also has paid services, which help to keep the project 'private'. In this article, we will focus on how to install Taiga behind your firewall and use it privately.

Installation

Taiga can be downloaded from <https://github.com/taigaio>. The Taiga platform consists of three main components: a) Taiga-back (the back-end API); b) Taiga-front (the front-end); and c) Taiga events.

The list of major dependencies of Taiga comprises the following:

- A) Runtime: (i) PostgreSQL>9.3 and (ii) RabbitMQ (optional)
- B) Compile time: (i) GCC and Development Headers, (ii) Ruby 2.1 and (iii) NodeJs 0.10

Because of space limitations, I will not cover the detailed installation process. It is pretty straightforward, so just follow the steps at <http://taigaio.github.io/taiga-doc/dist/setup-production.html>

Kanban template

Taiga provides two templates to choose from — Kanban and Scrum.

Let's explore Kanban first, which is used to manage knowledge work. In Kanban, everyone can see the status of events, from the definition of the project to the delivery to customers. Besides, team members can assign themselves